

Contributions Report

Translation Handbook (دليل الترجمة)

Draft for review

Prepared by Shaikhah Alkhaledi, editor of the draft

Working report on the draft handbook, for the Translation Team's review

Translation Team, Guild Professional Club

September 2026

1. About this report

- This is a working report by Shaikhah Alkhaledi, who edited the draft handbook. It explains how each team member's material was used: what was taken, what was edited, what was left out, and why.
- The handbook it describes is a **draft for the team's review**, not the final version. Every decision below can be discussed and changed.
- The report follows the current draft: two editions (Midnight and Light) with the same content, 98 pages, 9 parts and 27 chapters, an opening section (**Start here**) and a closing section (**Your journey continues**).
- Members are listed in alphabetical order. Chapter numbers refer to the current draft.
- The item-by-item record of every document is in the Appendix: The Team's Documents.

2. How material was chosen

Every point was judged by two questions: does a beginner need it, and is it correct? This led to six working rules:

1. Each idea is explained with an example before it is named, in numbered steps.
2. Each topic appears once, in the chapter where it belongs, even when several members covered it. Material that appeared in more than one member's notes was kept first, as the framework agreed.
3. Anything that could not be checked was left out rather than printed.
4. Examples that took a political or religious position were rewritten or left out.
5. History and specialist theory were kept to a minimum; they are available in other books.
6. Every idea taken from a published work is cited in brackets, and listed in the References.

3. Where each chapter comes from

The table shows the main source of each part of the draft, and what else was added to it.

Section	Main source	Also added
Start here	Written by Shaikhah Alkhaledi	The park-sign example; the House of Wisdom; the four steps
1 Translation and the translator	Samiaullah Mohammad (draft)	Shaikhah's notes: three kinds of translation, the translator as a reader; the Rosetta Stone
2 Tips, advice and preparation	Masooma Almesri (idea); Samiaullah (draft tips and plan)	Shaikhah's framework: the three questions (client, purpose, audience); a worked first translation

Section	Main source	Also added
3 Printed and digital dictionaries	Loulwah Bin Saeed (idea); Samiuallah (plan)	Written from published sources; كتاب العين
4 English and Arabic: key differences	Samiuallah (draft, 180 and Translation 1 notes)	Shaikhah's notes: <i>be, do, have</i> , the dual, gender of <i>I</i> and <i>you</i> ; Arabic numerals
5 Form and meaning	Samiuallah (draft)	—
6 Types of meaning	Samiuallah (draft)	Shaikhah's notes: lexical gaps, false equivalents, rare words
7 Context	Samiuallah (draft)	Shaikhah's notes: خط; the verb <i>run</i>
8 Collocation	Samiuallah (draft)	Shaikhah's notes: <i>deliver</i> ; 180 notes: <i>weak coffee, a rough sea</i>
9 Idioms, proverbs and fixed expressions	Samiuallah (draft)	Shaikhah's notes: fixed expressions, spotting idioms, five ways to translate them; 180 notes and الترجمة: ماهيتها وكييفيتها: three idioms
10 Equivalence	Samiuallah (draft)	Citation of Farghal & Shunnaq
11 Literal and free translation	Samiuallah (draft)	Communicative translation (requested in the Teams chat)
12 Metaphoric translation	Samiuallah (draft)	Masooma's slides: عقارب الساعة, a <i>throbbing headache</i>
13 The seven translation procedures	Samiuallah (plan); written from published sources	Examples from Samiuallah's Farghal & Shunnaq notes and draft: <i>shadow government, My friend speaks German fluently, A burnt child dreads the fire, garage</i>
14 Translation strategies	Samiuallah (draft and Translation 1 notes)	Explicitation and implicitation (Teams chat); further strategies; Shaikhah's notes: Arabic words in English
15 Cultural approximation	Samiuallah (draft)	Citation of Farghal & Shunnaq
16 Descriptive translation	Samiuallah (draft)	Citation of Farghal & Shunnaq
17 Lexical creation	Samiuallah (draft)	Shaikhah's notes: Arabicisation examples; Masooma's slides: الاستمطار,, affixes; the journey of <i>coffee</i>
18 Text analysis	Samiuallah (draft and Text Analysis Model)	—
19 Text types and genres	Samiuallah (plan); Shaikhah (framework)	Shaikhah's notes: news headlines, the inverted pyramid, technical and literary texts
20 Words and points of view	Samiuallah (plan: the relational model)	Written from published sources

Section	Main source	Also added
21 Terminology	Masooma and Samiuallah (terminology material from Masooma's slides)	Shaikhah's terminology class notes: the research steps; Shaikhah's notes: medical examples; UNTERM, Arabterm, a sample term list; the Damascus academy
22 Machine translation and AI	Samiuallah (draft: post-editing; plan)	Shaikhah's notes: translation memory, CAT tools, localisation; the 1954 demonstration
23 Revision and common mistakes	Samiuallah (plan); Shaikhah (framework)	Written from published sources
24 Interlingual risk assessment	Shaikhah (framework)	<i>The Mars Climate Orbiter</i>
25 Translation commentary	Samiuallah (draft and Text Analysis Model)	—
26 Introduction to audiovisual translation	Loulwah (AVT notes)	Shaikhah's notes: the Arabic dubbing of <i>The Simpsons</i> ; silent-film intertitles
27 Subtitling	Loulwah (AVT notes)	Subtitle timing, SDH, a five-step method, rules for Arabic subtitles
Your journey continues	Written by Shaikhah Alkhaledi	—

4. Loulwah Bin Saeed

Material received: the audiovisual translation notes (Intro to AVT and AVT 2), idiom notes, and her suggestion to include dictionaries. Her Principles of Translation notes, the Gamal article and the AVT Theory file have not yet reached the editor, and her other notes were lost.

A typed and organised version of the same notes (Audiovisual Translation.docx), posted by Samiuallah Mohammad, was compared with Chapters 26 and 27. It contains no new material: everything suitable for beginners was already in the handbook, and the parts left out are the same as below. It still gives the old line length (32 to 41 characters), which the handbook corrects. The parts left out would suit the website, as Samiuallah Mohammad suggested.

4.1 Taken into the handbook

What was taken	Where it is now
Why audiovisual translation matters, and what makes it different from other translation	Chapter 26, Step 1
The main types: subtitling, dubbing, voice-over and others	Chapter 26, Step 2
Dubbing, and dubbing in the Arab world	Chapter 26
Purpose comes first (Skopos theory)	Chapter 26; linked from Chapter 2
The challenges of the field	Chapter 26
Subtitles and their kinds (open and closed)	Chapter 27

What was taken	Where it is now
Words, images and sound work together	Chapter 27, Step 3
Language variety: sociolect, slang, idiolect	Chapter 27, Step 3
Cultural references and the subtitling strategies for them	Chapter 27, Step 4
Taboo language and censorship	Chapter 27, Step 5
The suggestion to include the dictionaries that helped the team and how to use them	Chapter 3, now in Part 1

4.2 Edited

- The two overlapping lists of subtitling strategies were merged into one list of eight.
- The spelling of Vermeer, Díaz Cintas and Remael was corrected.
- “32 to 41 characters per line” was corrected to about 37 to 39, and up to 42 on streaming platforms.
- “Relies 100% on technology” became “depends heavily on technology”.
- The description of dubbing in the Arab world was corrected.

4.3 Not taken, and why

Not taken	Why
The history of the field	Not needed to start subtitling.
Three of the four theories (descriptive translation studies, polysystem theory, reception studies)	Beyond a beginner's level; Skopos theory is kept because it is practical.
The summary on audiovisual translation in the Arab world	Kept short so that Part 9 stays practical.
Minor types (free commentary, in-vision signing, fansubs, surtitles)	The list was kept to the main types.
The YouTube links	Links stop working in a printed book.
The quotation on “screen translation”	Not needed once the term was explained.
The idiom notes	Several entries needed correcting (<i>my cup runneth over</i> , <i>rear-view mirror</i> , <i>just deserts</i>) or were incomplete, and most equivalents are colloquial.
The table of Kuwaiti expressions (from her framework instructions)	The handbook uses formal Arabic; the table would suit the website.

4.4 Added by the editor to her chapters

Subtitle display time and spotting, subtitles for the deaf and hard of hearing (SDH), a five-step subtitling method, a worked example of shortening a line, rules for Arabic subtitles, first steps for beginners, and the published sources that support the chapters (Díaz Cintas & Remael; Pedersen; Pérez-González; Gambier; Reiss & Vermeer).

5. Masooma Almesri

Material received: the terminology slides (182), the terminology material selected from them with Samiullah Mohammad, the TerminologyIdioms document, and her suggestion of an opening chapter of tips. Her Translation Texts document (180 and 386 texts) and her stylistics summary have not yet reached the editor.

5.1 Taken into the handbook

What was taken	Where it is now
The definition of terminology, and of a term	Chapter 21, Step 1
The four short forms: initialisms, acronyms, abbreviations, clippings (with the same examples)	Chapter 21, Step 1
The translator and the terminologist	Chapter 21, Step 2
The Arabic language academies	Chapter 21, Step 2
How to translate a term (meaning, origin, equivalent)	Chapter 21, Step 3
What makes a good term; do not change an accepted term without good reason; avoid redundant terms (التطرف الراديكالي)	Chapter 21, Steps 3 and 5
Termbases: what they are and what an entry contains	Chapter 21, Step 4
Why terms must be managed; one term for one idea	Chapter 21, Step 5
When dictionaries fail, think like a terminologist; a terminologist sometimes creates terms	Chapter 21, Step 3
Metaphor in terms: عقارب الساعة; <i>a throbbing headache</i>	Chapter 12, Step 3
Derivation and new meanings: قطار, الاستمطار; affix translation (<i>manageable</i> , <i>antibiotic</i>)	Chapter 17, Step 2
The idea of an opening chapter that prepares students before they start	Chapter 2

5.2 Edited

- The chapter was rewritten in plain English and reduced to what a beginner needs.
- The definition of a terminologist and some historical details were corrected.
- The chapter cited no sources, so sources were added (Cabr , 1999; UNTERM; Arabterm).

5.3 Not taken, and why

Not taken	Why
The history of terminology, its schools and its periods	History is not needed to use terms well.
Functions, points of view and user groups of terminology	Theory beyond a beginner's level.

Not taken	Why
Categories of terms by function, meaning and origin, and the types of borrowing	Too theoretical; the practical categories (short forms) are kept.
Most of the nine rules for naming terms	The practical rules are kept in one sentence.
The standardisation bodies (ISO, IEC, ITU) and types of standards	Too specialised for a first handbook.
The academies' detailed approval procedures	Too detailed; the academies themselves are kept.
Terminography and the fields of a termbase entry	Reduced to one sentence on what an entry contains.
The format for citing references	It belongs to the References style, not to the text.
Most of the idiom list	Mostly American slang, some about drinking; the common idioms are already in Chapter 9.

5.4 Added by the editor to her chapter

UNTERM and Arabterm, a sample term list, medical examples (*allergic*, *allergen*, *contact eczema*), the research steps from Shaikhah Alkhaledi's terminology class notes (see Section 7), and the Damascus academy and the Coordination Bureau of Arabization in Rabat.

6. Samiullah Mohammad

Material received: the typed version of the audiovisual translation notes (see Section 4), the first draft (Draft_one), the plan and recommendations (Latest updates and thoughts), the 180 course notes (typed and scanned), the Translation 1 notes, the notes on Farghal & Shunnaq, the Text Analysis Model, the text ما هيته وكيفيته الترجمة, the framework document and the main document.

6.1 The first draft: taken into the handbook

The draft had 175 points. 8 were used as written, 148 were used after editing, and 19 were not used. Its 25 headings became the backbone of the handbook:

Draft heading	Where it is now
Definitions and abbreviations	Key terms of each chapter; the Abbreviations list
Objectives of the book	Preface
Translation and the translator; qualities of a translator; commissioned and self-initiated translators	Chapter 1
Tips on how to translate; titles	Chapters 2 and 22
Arabic vs English	Chapter 4
Form vs meaning	Chapter 5
Types of meaning; sentence vs speaker meaning	Chapter 6
Context; homonymy and polysemy	Chapter 7

Draft heading	Where it is now
Collocation	Chapter 8
Idioms	Chapter 9
Equivalence	Chapter 10
Literal and free translation	Chapter 11
Metaphoric translation	Chapter 12
Translation strategies (two headings)	Chapter 14, with part in Chapter 17
Cultural approximation	Chapter 15
Descriptive translation	Chapter 16
Lexical creation	Chapter 17
Analysing a text (with the KUNA example)	Chapter 18
Post-editing	Chapter 22
Commentary on translation	Chapter 25
Terminology; AI and machine translation; glossary; references (empty headings)	Written in full: Chapters 21 and 22, the Glossary and the References

6.2 The first draft: edited

- Every section was rewritten as guided steps, and topics repeated in several places were merged.
- “Died” had the Arabic for “killed”: corrected.
- “Kick the bucket” was given with an insulting phrase (يموت كالحقير): it is now used to show that the idiom is informal and humorous, not insulting (Chapter 6).
- A line said form is more important than meaning: reversed, since meaning comes first.
- “Bush’s puppy”: the press said “poodle”.
- “Mark my words” was translated as a promise: corrected to تذکر کلامی.
- The rule that Arabic always starts with the verb: corrected (Arabic often starts with the verb, but not always).
- The Arabic equivalent of “is”: corrected.
- *Sam ate the cake* had been translated with “the apple” (التفاحة): corrected.
- *The Home Office* had been translated as a minister (وزير): corrected to a ministry (وزارة).
- Some “idiom” examples were really collocations: moved to Chapter 8.
- Colloquial Egyptian expressions were replaced with formal ones, and examples that took a political or religious position were rewritten to stay neutral.

6.3 The first draft: not taken, and why

Not taken	Why
“Principles = Foundations”	Its meaning is unclear.

Not taken	Why
"Arabic is compositional (derivational), English is compounding"	An oversimplification: both languages use derivation and compounding.
"Translation also means to politicize (الدبلوماسية)"	The wrong word, and not a definition of translation.
The communication model (sender, receiver, channel, noise)	Theory; the idea is kept in simple words.
"Why is meaning complex? Because it is cognitive"	Theory a beginner cannot use.
"Died = استشهد" as connotation	A religious and political word; replaced by تُوفِّي.
"Mule" as a synonym of "horse"	A mule is a different animal.
<i>Kill vs assassinated</i>	They differ in denotation, so they do not illustrate connotation.
"Most of the time, literal translation fails"	The book shows many successful literal translations.
"Kick the chair = انتحر"	Not an established English idiom.
<i>She is a snake</i> → إنها كالثعلب	Changes the image and contradicts the line before it.
أول الغيث قطرة for "the tip of the iceberg"	It means that big things start small.
The "74 fields" of the Jordanian academy	No source confirms the figure.
"Death is the great leveller = كل نفس ذائقة الموت"	A Qur'anic verse should not be used as a translation equivalent.
Colloquial register ("اتق الله يا شيخ", "وحدوا الله")	Not suitable for a general handbook.
Zakat as "an Islamic taxation system"	Factually wrong: zakat is on wealth, not income.
<i>Valentine's Day</i> = عيد الحب as a calque	It is not a loan translation.
Invented words (tribocracy, dictatocracy, puppycracy, patriocracy)	Not established English words.
"KUNA has biased views"	A handbook should not describe a named organisation this way.
The Clinton impeachment examples	A political scandal involving a named person.
Religious legal terms (الاستتابة, الخلوۃ الشرعية), Yin-Yang, <i>psychology vs psychiatry</i>	They belong to other fields; left out for space.
Some exercise items (<i>a readable book, a conceivable resolution, addled egg, Every Jack has his Jill</i>)	Left out for space; they could form an exercise set on the website.

6.4 The plan and recommendations

The plan contained 38 requests once repeated ones are merged.

Request	Status	Where it is now
Organise the material and remove repetition	Done	Whole book

Request	Status	Where it is now
Add missing strategies and types of translation	Done	Chapters 1, 11, 14, 26
A chapter on the seven procedures	Done	Chapter 13
Define key concepts in every chapter	Done	Words to remember, every chapter
A glossary of all terms	Partly done	Glossary of 113 terms; some terms used only in the text are not in it
Chapters on machine translation, text analysis, commentary, dictionaries, terminology	Done	Chapters 22, 18, 25, 3, 21
Tips and preparation at the beginning	Done	Chapter 2 and Start here
The three questions: client, purpose, audience	Done	Chapter 2
The main genres with examples; poetry examples	Done	Chapters 15 and 19
An interlingual risk assessment matrix	Done	Chapter 24
Common mistakes; an answer key with explanations	Done	Chapter 23; Try it in every chapter
News texts as authentic material	Partly done	Chapters 2, 18 and 19 (headlines and a short report)
Fairclough's relational model	Partly done	Chapter 20, as three practical questions
Collect examples from books, poetry, proverbs and idioms	Partly done	Chapters 9, 12, 15, 19
A final practice section at three levels; checklists; a note on future editions and the Arabic version	Done, then removed	Removed to keep the handbook short; see Section 8
Examples from "the book"	Not done	The book is not yet published
Sentences from the Analysis and 386 texts	Not done	Not yet received
Checklists based on the supervisor's framework	Not done	The framework was not received
References for the 180, 182 and other course materials	Partly done	Course materials cited as the Translation Team's notes

6.5 His course notes, the Text Analysis Model and {{الترجمة: ماهيتها وكيفيةها}}

- **The 180 notes, the Translation 1 notes and the Farghal & Shunnaq notes** turned out to be the sources of the draft, so almost all of their content was already in the handbook. Added from them: *Ali often goes to bed early* and *The students are in the laboratory* (Chapter 4); *weak coffee, a rough sea* and the collocations of يقطع (Chapter 8); *to be in the red* and *Business is business* (الشغل شغل) (Chapter 9); four examples of the seven procedures (Chapter 13); the citation of Farghal & Shunnaq in Chapters 4, 10,

12 and 15–17, in the 2011 edition the team used. The draft's numbered exercises come from this book.

- **The Text Analysis Model** is used in full, in simpler words: the three steps (analysis, translation, commentary); the linguistic level, with its micro level (words, grammar, meaning, word forms, sound) and macro level (the text, other texts, point of view); and the external level (background, author, audience). It is in Chapter 18, Step 3, with its use in the commentary (Chapter 25) and as a quality check (Chapter 23). Fairclough (2003), on which it is based, was added to the References. Not taken: blending, clippings, infixation, frame-modification, re-modelling, Al-ta'reed, monitoring, and intrinsic and extrinsic managing, which are too advanced.
- **الترجمة: ماهيتها وكيفيتها**: two idioms were taken (*He looks blue, I will go bananas*; Chapter 9). The rest was not quoted, because no author is named on any page and the text cannot be cited. Two of its examples needed correcting: “She is in the clouds” (the English idiom is “her head is in the clouds”) and مَهْد الطريق for “break the ice”.
- **His framework instructions**: the principles-then-examples pattern, simple language for beginners, and citation rules are followed throughout. The outline is the contents page. The abbreviations are at the back rather than the front, and the answer key is inside each chapter rather than at the end (see Section 8).

7. Shaikhah Alkhaledi

Shaikhah Alkhaledi edited the handbook and coordinated the project. Her contribution:

Contribution	Where it is now
Compiled the first draft of the framework from the four members' instructions and the team chat	Framework document
Planned the structure: 9 parts and 27 chapters from easy to hard; moved the dictionaries chapter into Part 1	Contents
Rewrote every chapter as a guided lesson (Where we are, numbered steps, Try it, Remember, Words to remember, Next) and proofread the whole book	Every chapter
Wrote the opening, Start here, and the closing section, Your journey continues	Front and end of the book
Study notes: the three kinds of translation; the translator as a reader	Chapter 1
Study notes: <i>be, do</i> and <i>have</i> (<i>She has her pills on time</i>); the dual (المحكمان); the gender of <i>I</i> and <i>you</i>	Chapter 4
Study notes: lexical gaps (تكلّى), false equivalents, rare words	Chapter 6
Study notes: خط, a word with several meanings	Chapter 7
Study notes: one verb, many partners (<i>deliver a letter, a speech, a verdict</i>)	Chapter 8
Study notes: fixed expressions; how to spot an idiom; five ways to translate one; three more idioms	Chapter 9

Contribution	Where it is now
Study notes: Arabic words borrowed into English (<i>algebra</i> , <i>algorithm</i>)	Chapter 14
Study notes: Arabicisation (استراتيجية, تكنولوجيا)	Chapter 17
Study notes: news headlines, the inverted pyramid, hard and soft news, technical and literary texts	Chapter 19
Study notes: medical terms (<i>allergic</i> , <i>allergen</i> , <i>contact eczema</i>)	Chapter 21
Study notes: translation memory, termbases, CAT tools, the development of machine translation, localisation	Chapter 22
Study notes: the Arabic dubbing of <i>The Simpsons</i>	Chapter 26
Terminology class notes, extracted by her from the terminology course she took: terms of several words; reading about a new field and asking a specialist; checking a term's parts against its context; confirming an equivalent in an original Arabic text; one-sentence definitions; terms with two accepted names	Chapter 21, Steps 1 and 3–5
Framework proposals: the translation brief; the terminology guide; genre guidance; common pitfalls; the risk matrix; UNTERM and digital tools	Chapters 2, 17, 19, 21, 22, 23, 24
Added from published sources where the team's material had gaps: the seven procedures; communicative translation; explicitation and implicitation; genres; dictionaries; common mistakes	Chapters 3, 11, 13, 14, 19, 23
Ten "Did you know?" boxes and a "Next" line at the end of every chapter	Chapters 1–4, 7, 17, 21, 22, 24, 26; every chapter
Removed everything tied to a date, an event or a product, so that the book can be used every year	Whole book
Wrote two one-page guides: The translator's workflow (with Do and Don't boxes) and When in doubt	End of Part 1; before the closing section
Wrote a Translation quality checklist and a final task, Put it all together, which takes one short press release through every step of the book	End of Part 8; after Chapter 27
Revised the wording of rules and claims so that they read as tendencies, not absolute laws, and marked the preferred Arabic term where two exist	Chapters 4, 10, 11, 20, 22, 27; Glossary
Reviewed every example against the team's documents and her notes: team examples kept and corrected; weak examples replaced, preferably with team examples; challenge questions added	Chapters 1–27
Designed the two covers (Midnight and Light), the page layout and the QR code; designed and developed the Translation Team's website	Covers; inside pages; website

7.1 Her proposals not taken, and why

Not taken	Why
The parallel-texts step ("Intertextual Mapping Protocol") and the ethics checklist ("Invisible Translator" audit)	They need texts and practice; they suit the website or a later edition. Parallel texts are mentioned in Your journey continues.
"Dynamic Syntactic Restructuring" as a separate module	Partly covered by word order and verb-first sentences in Chapter 4.
The practice section, answer key and checklists	Written, then removed to keep the handbook short.
The website's Practice Arena and other features	They belong on the website, which carries what changes; the book carries what lasts.

8. Removed from the whole draft, and why

Removed	Why
The practice section at three levels and its answer key	Too long for a handbook; each chapter keeps its Try it questions with answers.
The four checklists at the end	They repeated the chapter summaries.
The note on future editions and the Arabic version	A printed book cannot keep being updated; the website carries later material.
Scholars' names in the running text	Easier reading; every idea keeps its citation in brackets.
References to the courses and the lecturers	The handbook is meant to be used on its own.
Part descriptions and about a third of the running text	Repetition and long explanations made the pages heavy.
Examples tied to a date or event	So that the book stays valid every year.
Placeholders, unconfirmed reviewers' names and mentions of the Guild Season	Not final or not confirmed.

9. Still open for the team

Because this is a draft, the following need the team's decision:

- The order and titles on the Contributors page: the framework agreed that all four names appear equally.
- Whether to name the academic supervisor, Abdullah Bezea, in the handbook.
- The club's official name: the draft says "Guild Professional Club"; the team's main document says "The Professional English Club: Guild".
- Whether the material not yet received should go into this edition: Loulwah's Principles of Translation notes, the Gamal article and AVT Theory; Masooma's Translation Texts and stylistics summary; the three sample analyses.

- The page size: B5 now; A5 was the size of the model book.
- Before printing: a full read by a native Arabic specialist; checking the ten Did you know? facts and the open reference points listed in the Final Report.